

each category, purchasing dots in the Traits associated with each one. One point buys one dot in a Trait.

Unlike Attributes, however, you do not begin with one dot in each Ability; you must purchase them from scratch. In addition, you may not purchase more than three dots of an Ability at this time — if you want to be a true master of an Ability, you will have to purchase more dots with freebie points (or experience points during play). You may otherwise allocate your Ability points as you see fit within a category.

Step Three: Advantages

A character's *Advantages* can represent a wide variety of things, from the *Backgrounds* that help define her life, to the magical *Arts* she can draw upon to wield fae magic, and the *Realms* that dictate upon what she can work her magic. Unlike Attributes and Abilities, you do not prioritize in these categories; you simply receive a set amount of points for each one and spend them as you see fit to realize your idea of your character.

Backgrounds

Every character receives five points to allocate among different *Backgrounds*. One point buys one dot of a Background, and you may buy up to five points right away; they are not limited to three points at this stage as Abilities are.

Backgrounds are a very broad category, with some representing elements that are external to the character, such as friends, special locations, or even magical items, while others are internal and represent unusual innate qualities a character possesses. Some Backgrounds require additional details or rules adjudication, such as magical Treasures or clever Chimera companions, to determine how they interact with game mechanics; this can be worked out later with the Storyteller.

Depending on the nature of the chronicle, the Storyteller may limit or even forbid particular Backgrounds, so make sure to check to see if any such restrictions are in place before purchasing them. For instance, if the characters are all supposed to be down on their luck circus performers, the Storyteller may declare that no one has more than one level of Resources, if any, reflecting their hand-to-mouth lifestyle.

Arts and Realms

All Kithain possess some measure of magical ability after their Chrysalis, and while learning new cantrips is both difficult and time consuming, those that dedicate themselves to the study of changeling magic can become formidable and unpredictable foes.

Arts determine the broad type of magic your character can wield. You have three points to spend on Arts. While a quick reference table is provided later in this chapter, it is a good idea to at least glance at the full descriptions

